the G20 governance group, which has regularly brought together both the G7 and the BRICS and supported the interests of both members' clubs since the first BRICS summit in 2009.[178]

Equally important is the signal by the BRICS that they have strongly supplemented their hybrid strategy of inside reforms with outside options, which was an important turning point in their group relations and their interaction with the incumbent powers who have dominated global economic governance since the end of the Second World War. However, the BRICS did not transition into an oppositional stance as *spoilers*, nor it is accurate anymore to label them as *shirkers*. The BRICS are not engaged in a hostile takeover or a "destroy and replace" mission. They are persistent, disruptive change agents led by China, the most important competitor to the United States since the Soviet Union. The global financial crisis, prolonged delays by Washington to ratify the 2010 IMF quota reforms, and other acts of incumbent power resistance, such as only token attempts by the Obama administration to include any of the BRICS in the Trans-Pacific Partnership (TPP), shows both cracks in the order and increased U.S. sensitivity to China's rise. There is an increasing U.S. tendency to hedge on its commitment to integrate China and the BRICS as a group into a benevolent and legitimate negotiated liberal order[179] as China and the other BRICS have taken one step closer toward its possible replacement.

The next chapter alters the analytical focus from the group to the individual countries, discussing each country's mixed motivations for cooperation in international financial statecraft. It investigates specific propositions about the intentions of BRICS countries regarding these and other issues central to their collaboration.